

TechNova Inc.

Employee Policy Handbook 2025-2026

Human Resources Department

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1. Leave Policies

1.1 Annual Leave (Paid Time Off)

All full-time employees are entitled to 24 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Annual leave accrues at the rate of 2 days per month of completed service. Employees must submit leave requests at least 5 working days in advance through the HR Portal (portal.technova.internal). Approval is subject to project requirements and manager discretion. Unused annual leave may be carried forward up to a maximum of 10 days into the next calendar year. Any leave beyond 10 days that remains unused by March 31 of the following year will be forfeited without compensation.

1.2 Maternity Leave

Female employees who have completed at least 80 days of service in the 12 months preceding the expected date of delivery are entitled to 26 weeks (182 days) of paid maternity leave. This applies to the first two surviving children. For employees with two or more surviving children, the entitlement is 12 weeks (84 days). Maternity leave may be taken up to 8 weeks before the expected date of delivery. During maternity leave, the employee will receive full salary and all benefits will continue. Employees returning from maternity leave are guaranteed the same position or an equivalent role with the same pay grade. The company also provides a nursing facility on the 3rd floor of the Bhopal headquarters.

1.3 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to 15 working days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption of a child. This benefit is available for up to two children. Paternity leave requests must be submitted at least 2 weeks in advance and require a birth certificate or adoption order as supporting documentation.

1.4 Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Sick leave for 3 or more consecutive days requires a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner. Unused sick leave does not carry forward and cannot be encashed. In case of extended illness (beyond 12 days), employees may apply for medical leave without pay or utilize their annual leave balance, subject to HR approval and medical documentation.

1.5 Bereavement Leave

In the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, parent, child, sibling, or parent-in-law), employees are entitled to 5 working days of paid bereavement leave. For extended family members (grandparents, aunts, uncles, cousins), 3 working days of paid leave are provided. No documentation is required, but employees must notify their manager as soon as possible.

2. Remote Work & Hybrid Policy

2.1 Hybrid Work Model

TechNova operates a hybrid work model. Employees are required to work from the office a minimum of 3 days per week (Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday are mandatory in-office days). Monday and Friday are designated as flexible work-from-home days. Team leads may designate additional in-office days for specific project phases with at least 1 week of advance notice.

2.2 Full Remote Work Eligibility

Full-time remote work arrangements are available to employees who have completed at least 18 months of service, have received a performance rating of 'Exceeds Expectations' or higher in the most recent review cycle, and whose role does not require physical presence (e.g., hardware lab work, client-facing roles). Applications for full remote work must be submitted to the employee's manager and HR. Decisions are made within 10 working days. Remote employees must maintain availability during core hours (10:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST) and attend quarterly in-office days for team alignment.

2.3 Equipment & Internet Allowance

Remote and hybrid employees receive a one-time home office setup allowance of INR 25,000 for ergonomic equipment (desk, chair, monitor). Additionally, a monthly internet reimbursement of INR 1,500 is provided upon submission of the ISP bill. All company-issued equipment (laptops, monitors, peripherals) must be returned within 7 days of separation from the company.

3. Travel & Expense Reimbursement

3.1 Domestic Travel

Category	Economy Class	Business Class	Hotel Per Night	Per Diem (Food)
Junior (L1-L3)	Yes	No	Up to INR 5,000	INR 1,500
Mid-level (L4-L6)	Yes	Flights > 4 hrs	Up to INR 8,000	INR 2,000
Senior (L7+)	Yes	Yes	Up to INR 12,000	INR 3,000
Director & above	Yes	Yes	Up to INR 20,000	INR 5,000

3.2 International Travel

All international travel requires pre-approval from the Department Head and Finance. Business class is approved for flights exceeding 6 hours. Hotel accommodations are booked through the company's preferred travel agency (TravelDesk). Employees must submit all receipts and a detailed expense report within 10 working days of return via the Expense Management System (expense.technova.internal). Reimbursements are processed within 15 working days of approved submission. Personal expenses, alcohol, and entertainment costs are not reimbursable.

3.3 Mileage Reimbursement

Employees using personal vehicles for official travel are reimbursed at INR 12 per kilometer for cars and INR 6 per kilometer for two-wheelers. Mileage claims must include origin, destination, purpose, and odometer readings. Commuting between home and the regular office is not eligible for mileage reimbursement.

4. Information Security Policy

4.1 Data Classification

All company data is classified into four levels: (1) PUBLIC - information intended for external distribution (press releases, marketing materials). (2) INTERNAL - general company information not intended for external sharing (org charts, internal newsletters). (3) CONFIDENTIAL - sensitive business information (financial reports, strategic plans, customer data). Access restricted to authorized personnel. (4) RESTRICTED - highest sensitivity (trade secrets, source code, personal data under DPDP Act 2023). Access on a strict need-to-know basis with encryption required at rest and in transit.

4.2 Password & Authentication Policy

All employees must use multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all company systems. Passwords must be at least 14 characters, include uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters, and be changed every 90 days. Password reuse is prohibited for the last 12 passwords. Biometric authentication is required for accessing RESTRICTED data systems. Company-issued hardware security keys (YubiKey) must be used for VPN and cloud platform access.

4.3 Acceptable Use of AI Tools

Employees may use approved AI tools (listed on the IT Portal at it.technova.internal/ai-approved) for productivity enhancement. CONFIDENTIAL and RESTRICTED data must NEVER be entered into external AI tools including ChatGPT, Gemini, or any third-party AI service. Employees must use the company's internally

deployed AI assistant (TechNova AI, accessible at ai.technova.internal) for any queries involving sensitive data. Violations of this policy will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. All AI interactions on company systems are logged and auditable.

5. Performance Review Process

5.1 Review Cycle

TechNova conducts performance reviews twice a year: Mid-Year Review (July) and Annual Review (January). The Annual Review determines compensation adjustments, promotions, and bonus allocations. Reviews use a 5-point rating scale: (1) Needs Improvement, (2) Meets Some Expectations, (3) Meets Expectations, (4) Exceeds Expectations, (5) Outstanding. Employees rated 1 or 2 are placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) lasting 90 days.

5.2 360-Degree Feedback

All employees at L4 level and above participate in 360-degree feedback, which includes self-assessment, manager assessment, peer feedback (minimum 3 peers), and direct report feedback (for managers). Feedback is anonymous for peers and direct reports. The compiled feedback report is shared with the employee during the review meeting.

5.3 Compensation & Bonus

Annual salary increments are determined by performance rating and market benchmarking. The company targets the 65th percentile of industry compensation. Performance bonuses range from 0% to 25% of annual base salary: Rating 5 = 20-25%, Rating 4 = 12-18%, Rating 3 = 5-10%, Rating 2 = 0-3%, Rating 1 = 0%. Stock options (ESOPs) are awarded to employees at L5 and above with a 4-year vesting schedule (25% per year). Promotion decisions require a minimum rating of 4 and manager recommendation.

6. Employee Benefits

6.1 Health Insurance

TechNova provides comprehensive group health insurance covering the employee, spouse, and up to 2 dependent children. Coverage: INR 10,00,000 (10 lakhs) per family per year. The policy includes hospitalization, day-care procedures, maternity coverage (after 9 months of waiting period), and mental health consultations (up to 20 sessions per year). Pre-existing conditions are covered after a 2-year waiting period. Employees may opt for a top-up plan of an additional INR 10,00,000 at a subsidized premium of INR 3,500 per year.

6.2 Learning & Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of INR 50,000 for courses, certifications, conferences, and books. Reimbursement requires pre-approval from the manager and submission of completion certificates. The company also provides free access to LinkedIn Learning, Coursera Enterprise, and O'Reilly Safari. Employees pursuing higher education (MBA, MS) may apply for the Education Assistance Program, which covers up to 50% of tuition fees (capped at INR 3,00,000 per year) subject to a 2-year service commitment after course completion.

6.3 Employee Wellness

The Bhopal headquarters includes a fully equipped gym (open 6 AM - 10 PM), yoga studio, and meditation room. Virtual wellness sessions are available for remote employees every Wednesday at 5 PM IST. The company provides an Employee Assistance Program (EAP) through MindSpace Wellness, offering confidential counseling for personal, financial, and work-related issues. The EAP helpline (1800-XXX-XXXX) is available 24/7.

7. Code of Conduct

7.1 Anti-Harassment & Discrimination

TechNova maintains a zero-tolerance policy against harassment, discrimination, and bullying based on gender, race, religion, caste, age, disability, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic. The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), constituted under the POSH Act 2013, handles all complaints of sexual harassment. Complaints can be filed through the HR Portal, via email to icc@technova.com, or in person with any ICC member. All complaints are investigated within 90 days and kept strictly confidential.

7.2 Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any financial interest, secondary employment, or personal relationship that could create a conflict of interest with their role at TechNova. This includes but is not limited to: employment with or consulting for competitors, investment in competitor companies exceeding INR 1,00,000, and personal relationships with vendors or clients that could influence business decisions. Disclosures must be made to the Ethics Committee via ethics@technova.com within 30 days of the conflict arising.

8. Grievance & Escalation Procedures

8.1 Grievance Filing Process

Employees who have a workplace grievance should first attempt to resolve it through direct conversation with their immediate manager. If the issue remains unresolved, the employee may file a formal grievance through the HR Portal (portal.technova.internal/grievance). All formal grievances are acknowledged within 2 working days and assigned to an HR Business Partner. The investigation and resolution process takes a maximum of 30 working days. Employees may request escalation to the Chief People Officer if they are unsatisfied with the resolution.

8.2 Whistleblower Protection

TechNova encourages employees to report any unethical, illegal, or unsafe conduct through the confidential Whistleblower Hotline (1800-XXX-YYYY) or email (whistleblower@technova.com). Reports may be made anonymously. The company guarantees protection against retaliation for good-faith reports. The Audit Committee reviews all whistleblower complaints quarterly. Substantiated findings are reported to the Board of Directors.

8.3 Separation & Exit Process

Employees wishing to resign must serve a notice period of 30 days (L1-L4) or 60 days (L5 and above). Early release from the notice period is at the company's discretion and may require notice period buyout at the daily gross salary rate. During the notice period, employees must complete a knowledge transfer plan approved by their manager, return all company assets (laptop, ID card, access badges, security keys), and attend an exit interview conducted by HR. Full and final settlement is processed within 45 days of the last working day.

This handbook is a living document and is updated periodically. The latest version is always available on the HR Portal. In case of any discrepancy between this document and the terms of your employment contract, the employment contract shall prevail. For questions or clarifications, contact hr@technova.com or visit the HR desk on the 2nd floor of the Bhopal headquarters.

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